

EDUCATION

Georgia Institute of Technology, Ph.D. Candidate, Human-Centered Computing Aug 2022 - est. May 2027

- *Dissertation*: “Broadening Pathways in Computing”
- *Advisor*: Besty DiSalvo
- *Committee*: Tawanna Dillahunt, Becki Grinter, Judith Uchidiuno, Bhumika Chauhan

School of the Museum of Fine Arts at Tufts University, Bachelor of Fine Arts, Boston, MA Aug 2009 – May 2011

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Georgia Institute of Technology, Graduate Research Assistant, Culture and Technology Lab Aug 2022 – Present

PUBLICATIONS

Full Papers

Lara Karki, Hannah Grosswieser, Eureka Wagner-Kobayashi, Ian P. Swift, Michael Muller, Dana Priest, Robert Wolfe, and Betsy DiSalvo. “The Post-Builder Perspective: Recognizing the Computing Work & Labor of Everyday People.” *Under review for CHI 2027*.

Lara Karki, Kayla Uleah, Carl DiSalvo, Sierra Traynail Ross, Jadin Butler, Selamawit Husein, Emanuel Bryant, Dana Priest, Justin Booker, and Betsy DiSalvo. 2025. “I get hives when I come on here’: Persisting Through Platform-Delivered Microaggressions on LinkedIn.” *Proc. ACM Hum.-Comput. Interact.* 9, 7, Article CSCW232 (November 2025), 36 pages. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3757413>

Lara Karki, Dana Priest, et al. 2025. “A Window into DataWorks: Developing an Integrated Work-Training Curriculum for Novice Adults”. In *Proceedings of the 56th ACM Technical Symposium on Computer Science Education V. 1 (SIGSESETS 2025)*. Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, 568–574. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3641554.3701826>

Carl DiSalvo, Annabel Rothschild, **Lara L. Schenck**, Ben Rydal Shapiro, and Betsy DiSalvo. 2024. When Workers Want to Say No: A View into Critical Consciousness and Workplace Democracy in Data Work. *Proc. ACM Hum.-Comput. Interact.* 8, CSCW1, Article 156 (April 2024), 24 pages. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3637433>

Short Papers

Lara Karki, Aarti Israni, Kayla Uleah, Tawanna Dillahunt, Julie Hui, and Betsy DiSalvo. “Beyond the User vs. Builder Binary: Reframing Computing Work and Occupations.” *Accepted Case Study for GROUP 2027*.

Lara Karki, Aarti Israni, Tawanna Dillahunt, Julie Hui, Dana Priest, Asher Brown, and Betsy DiSalvo. 2026. Recognizing, Supporting, and Futuring Diverse Pathways in Computing Work. In *Adjunct Proceedings of the 5th Annual Symposium on Human-Computer Interaction for Work (CHIWORK Adjunct '26)*. Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, Article 33, 1–4. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3805029.3818267>

Lara L. Schenck and Betsy DiSalvo. 2023. From Data Work to Data Science: Getting Past the Gatekeepers. In *Proceedings of the 2023 ACM Conference on International Computing Education Research - Volume 2 (ICER '23)*, Vol. 2. Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, 1–2. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3568812.3603468>

Manuscripts in Preparation

“Epistemologies of Programming” with Idel Martinez-Ramos, Sabine Verdult, Dana Priest, Asher Brown, Feliene Hermans, and Betsy DiSalvo. *In preparation*.

“Research through Career Development” with Asher Brown, Dana Priest, Joshua Fortier, Briana Evans-Lopez, Oschaya Ellis, Justin Booker, and Betsy DiSalvo. *In preparation.*

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Georgia Institute of Technology, *Instructor of Record*

Atlanta, GA

- Cognitive Science & LLMs (CS 8001) May 2026 – Aug 2026
- Research Seminar (CS 8903) Aug 2025 – Present
 - AI & Hiring (10 students across 3+ terms) Aug 2025 – Present
 - Software Engineering Labor Conditions (1 student) Aug 2026 – Present
 - DataWorks Business Development (2 students) Aug 2026 – Present

Georgia Institute of Technology, *Graduate Teaching Assistant*

Atlanta, GA

- Creative Design Practice (CS 8803); Instructor: Carl DiSalvo Jan 2026 – May 2026
- Intro to Ph.D. Studies (CS 8803); Instructor: Betsy DiSalvo Aug 2025 – Dec 2025

Additional Teaching

National

- DataWorks @ Georgia Tech, *Career Development Founder & Facilitator* – Atlanta, GA 2022 – 2025
- University of Southern California, *Adjunct Instructor; WordPress Development* – Los Angeles, CA 2018
- Pratt Institute of Design, *Adjunct Instructor; UI/UX Prototyping in Code, Coding I-II* – New York, NY 2015 – 2016
- Decoded, *Executive Education Facilitator; Code in a Day* – New York, NY 2014 – 2016
- General Assembly, *Lead Instructor; Front-End Web Development* – New York, NY 2013 – 2014

PRESENTATIONS

Invited Talks

- Are LLMs making me dumber?, Allegheny County Department of Human Services, Pittsburgh 2026
- Cognition and LLMs, Responsible AI Group, Merck, Rahway 2025
- Platform Delivered Microaggressions on LinkedIn, STS Symposium at Georgia Tech 2023

Conference Presentations

- Recognizing, Supporting, and Futuring Diverse Pathways in Computing, CHIWORK 2026, Linz 2026
- Platform Delivered Microaggressions on LinkedIn, CSCW 2025, Bergen 2025
- A Window into DataWorks, SIGCSE TS 2025, Pittsburgh 2025
- Re-thinking Skill in Times of Technological Change, Critical Computing Group at Georgia Tech 2024
- Novice-Friendly Computational Work, ICER 2023, Chicago 2023
- CSS Algorithms, StrangeLoop, St. Louis 2019
- Is CSS a Programming Language?, Abstractions, Pittsburgh 2019
- CSS Algorithms, JS Conf US, San Diego 2019
- Writing CSS Algorithms, CSS Camp, Barcelona 2019
- Algorithms of CSS, CSS Day, Amsterdam (invited) 2019
- Bridging the Gap Between Design & Development at WordCamp US, Nashville 2018
- The Algorithms of CSS at CSSConf EU, Berlin 2018
- Let's Build A Gutenberg Block Workshop at WordCamp EU, Belgrade 2018
- Why the Designer Failed FizzBuzz at SassConf, Austin 2015
- Freelancing, Real Talk at WordCamp, New York City 2014

Doctoral Consortia and Workshop Participation

- ACM Future Leaders of AI Doctoral Consortium, Atlanta 2026
- Critical Futures of Work Workshop, CSCW 2025, Bergen 2025
- CRA Women in Computing, San Francisco 2023

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Merck, Commercial AI Capabilities Intern, Rahway, NJ

June 2025 – Aug 2025

- Developed a 4-pillar human-centered AI roadmap for Merck commercial leadership through a 25-stakeholder diagnostic spanning Human Health, Animal Health, and R&D; identified critical adoption bottlenecks and force-ranked priorities across adoption, empowerment, human-AI collaboration, and governance.
- Translated academic research into actionable strategy through presentations to AI Leadership, Responsible AI group (100+ members), and Human Health division; designed protocols identifying user segments and barriers in Gen AI product adoption.

Penske Media Corporation, Principal Software Engineer, Los Angeles, CA

June 2018 – May 2022

- Identified gap design and engineering processes causing slow platform migrations and poor cross-functional communication; built business case and secured executive buy-in, then led full-scale implementation, increasing re-platforming capacity by 60%.
- Led change management through documentation, training, and communication channels, facilitating alignment across an 80-person product and engineering organization.

Lara Schenck LLC, Founder & Technical Consultant, Pittsburgh, PA and New York, NY

Aug 2011 – June 2018

- Managed and executed end-to-end client engagements across branding, design, development, strategy, and technical training for 30+ clients including The Weather Channel and Barnes & Noble, small businesses, and startups.
- Established thought leadership through speaking at 19+ international industry conferences (audiences of 500+ and 40k+ recording views), developing and teaching online courses, and publishing tutorials and online.

FELLOWSHIPS & AWARDS

Foley Scholar Finalist, Institute for People and Technology, Georgia Institute of Technology

2026

Graduate Research Fellowship (\$159,000), National Science Foundation

2023-2027

Pathbreakers Fellowship (\$34,000), Georgia Institute of Technology

2024

President's Fellowship, Georgia Institute of Technology

2022

RESEARCH MENTORING

Elizabeth Jamison, M.S. Computer Science, Georgia Tech

2026 – Present

Austin Fulbright, M.S. Computer Science, Georgia Tech

2026 – Present

Grace Gong, M.S. Computer Science, Georgia Tech

2026 – Present

Justin W. Thomas, M.S. Computer Science, Georgia Tech

2026 – Present

Alicia N. Bochnak, M.S. Computer Science, Georgia Tech

2025 – Present

Marine Regnault, M.S. Computer Science, Georgia Tech

2025 – Present

James T. Roberts, M.S. Computer Science, Georgia Tech

2025 – Present

Yashika Reddy, B.S. Computer Science, Georgia Tech

2025 – Present

Dana Priest, Training Coordinator, DataWorks, Georgia Tech

2022 – Present

Saurabh Kalia, M.S. Computer Science, Georgia Tech

2025 – 2026

Kunyeul Lee, M.S. Computer Science, Georgia Tech

2026

Minhaz Jisan, M.S. Computer Science, Georgia Tech

2026

Eric Oliphant, M.S. Computer Science, Georgia Tech

2026

Ding (Dean) Ding Tian, M.S. Computer Science, Georgia Tech

2025

Alésandra Baca-Vazques, Ph.D. Human-Centered Computing, Georgia Tech

2025

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Lead Organizer, Workshop at CHIWORK 2026, Linz

2026

Co-Organizer, ATL Pre-CHI Event, Atlanta SIGCHI Chapter, Atlanta

2026

Co-Founder , “IC Buddies” Ph.D. Mentor Program, Georgia Institute of Technology	2025
Reviewer GROUP (2026), TOCE (2023, 2025, 2026), CHI (2025, 2027), CSCW (2025), SIGCSE (2024, 2025), DIS (2023)	
Participant , GVU Showcase, Institute for People and Technology, Georgia Institute of Technology	2023 – 2025
Founder & Organizer , CSS.la Meetup, Los Angeles	2018-2019
Volunteer , WordCamp LA Conference, Los Angeles	2018
Founder & Organizer , CodePen NYC Meetup, New York	2014-2016